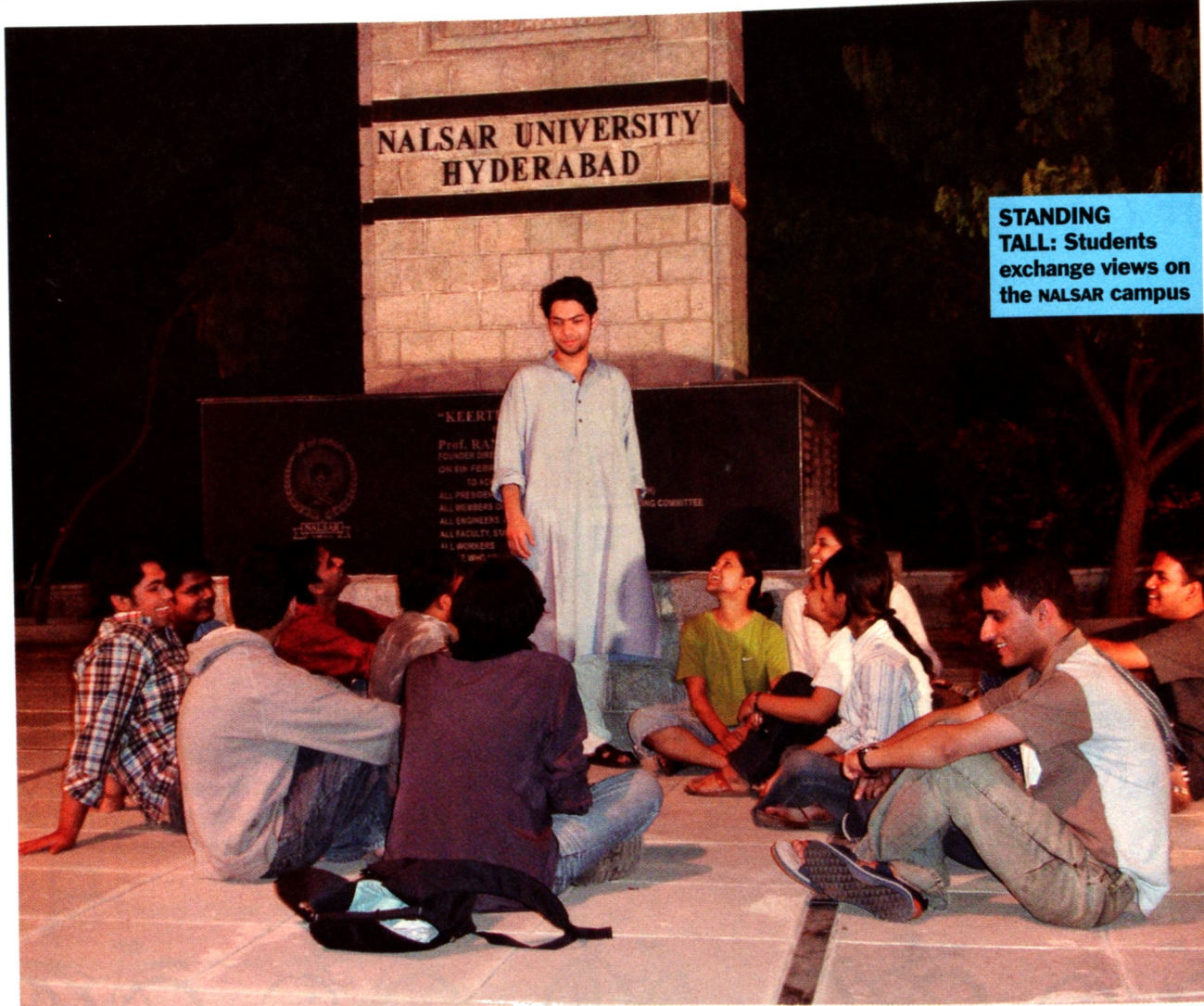




STANDING TALL: Students exchange views on the NALSAR campus

economy, access to top MNCs and low government salaries ensure that top law brains are absorbed by market forces. The ones who are not lured by the lucre will anyway volunteer their services as is already being done by many NLSIU products."

Last year, the law school's executive council, which includes the chief justice of India, got a pleasant surprise when Clifford Chancem, one of the world's best-known law firms, awarded training contracts to 12 students of the school. The good thing, however, is that many NLSIU alumni do leave law firms mid-career to move into full-time litigation, social development or to go back to teaching.

Apart from NLSIU, institutes like the NALSAR University of Law in Hyderabad, and NLIU in Bhopal have been doing well too. "Our courses are comprehensive and multi-dimen-

sional, enabling students to be socially relevant, technically competent and professionally sound," says Professor Ranbir Singh, vice-chancellor, NALSAR University of Law. The facilities at the institute include video conferencing which facilitates the creation of a virtual classroom that helps students share their views on several issues. This facility was introduced in 2006. The college has a teachers' convention centre for both resident and visiting faculty and a moot court hall.

Standing in the third position, NLIU too boasts of state-of-the-art facilities, besides a highly accomplished body of students and faculty. From hoary legal journals like *All India Reporter (AIR)* and *Criminal Law Journal (CLJ)* to internationally acclaimed ones like *Harvard Law Journal*, *Postal Law Review* and

Columbia Law Review, NLIU students have reached out far and wide. Says NLIU Director, Professor Balraj Chauhan: "Legal research is the cornerstone of our success and Madhya Pradesh provides us a fertile ground for some of the most complex legal situations in a variety of sectors like forest, environmental law and corporate accountability."

Similarly, the National Law University in Jodhpur, which has secured the fourth rank, focuses on an integrated study of law. It offers facilities for inter-disciplinary subjects like medicine, science and technology. It also has research centres offering specialised facilities in banking, insurance, finance and criminal law among many others. Obviously, such innovations have helped universities make a difference.

with Amamath K. Menon in Hyderabad and Ambresh Mishra in Bhopal